Submission Worksheet

Submission Data

Course: IT265-002-S2026
Assignment: IT265 Design Treatment Checkpoint
Student: Nicolas M. (nlm25)
Status: Submitted | **Worksheet Progress:** 64%
Potential Grade: 4.00/10.00 (40.00%)
Received Grade: 0.00/10.00 (0.00%)
Started: 3/2/2026 9:19:16 PM
Updated: 3/2/2026 11:59:14 PM
Grading Link: https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-design-treatment-checkpoint/grading/nlm25
View Link: https://learn.ethereallab.app/assignment/v3/IT265-002-S2026/it265-design-treatment-checkpoint/view/nlm25

Instructions

Objective: Individually create a detailed design treatment for an original board game, covering the concept, gameplay mechanics, visual style, target audience, and inclusivity features. This foundational work will lead to further development phases.

1. Work on the below tasks (recommended to do in the order provided). 2, After you have the core concepts/sketches seek external feedback from 3 different people, preferably people from your target audience
2. Once all items are filled out, ensure this worksheet is saved and explore the PDF
3. Upload the PDF to a branch called `DesignTreatment` on GitHub
4. Create a pull request to main, and complete the merge
5. Upload the same PDF to Canvas

Section #1: (2 pts.) Crafting The Game Treatment

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (0.29 pts.) - Possible Title(s) of the Game

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Propose fitting title(s) reflecting the game's essence
- Explanation of title(s) choices

Your Response:

One of my original concepts for this game was to make a something akin to Pokemon

but with more sophisticated combat, so a possible title could be a play on that. I figure a name like "**Field Beasts**" would be a proper mix between originality and blatant parody, while also making it clear that your "monsters" will not be restricted to your "pocket" in this game.

Another avenue for naming could be to focus solely on certain parts of the gameplay with some kind of animal pun (my current plan is to use real life animals as characters instead of fictional monsters). I could try and focus on the freedom of movement with a name like "**Stampede**", or I could focus on the strategic side with something like "**War Hogs**".

If it isn't obvious by these awful name idead, I have not yet put any thoughts at all into what this game would be named.

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Task #2 (0.29 pts.) - Game Setting

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the setting

Your Response:

I haven't landed on a specific setting idea, for the board game prototype my only true setting will be the hexagonal grid on which the game will take place.

In terms of story or set dressing for the final project, I am considering keeping the setting as grounded as possible. A deep forest or woodlands is what first comes to mind, or perhaps a wetland like the Great Swamp here in New Jersey. If I were to choose a place to use as inspiration, my first choice would be the Appalacian Mountains because of its notoriously ominous vibes and urban legends.

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Task #3 (0.29 pts.) - Game Characters

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the characters

Your Response:

My idea is to be a twist on games like Pokemon, while also retaining a grounded

setting, so I decided the units/creatures the players control should all be real animals. I want them to fit the environment the game will take place in. If I stick to forests I will use animals like bears, birds, squrriels, wolves and moose. If I choose something more domestic I'll instead use pets or farm animals.

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Task #4 (0.29 pts.) - Game Theme

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the theme

Your Response:

The board game prototype can't really have any big themes due to it just being a test of combat. But for the final project game I have an interesting idea. I've had an idea rattling in my head on how I can make a twist on Pokemon's themes. I've always considered Pokemon to be a cowardly series in how it is impossible to lose your companions. I think it would be far more impactful to make a game themed around permanently losing the companions you care for. Players will be far more careful about their decisions if they risk permanently losing the creatures they love the most.

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Task #5 (0.29 pts.) - Game Story

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Thoroughly describe the story

Your Response:

If I were able to fit a story into my game, my first idea would be about the players finding their way into a secluded place where something is terribly wrong with the animals. The creatures of the forest are turning monstrous and aggressive, and the player must form a team and build bonds with the creatures that still remain sane to survive.

On a completely different idea, the arts and crafts store near my home had a crazy diverse set of farm animal figurines, which made me think it would be quite funny if the game was just a big chaotic prison riot breaking out on a farm and all the animals started brawling.

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Task #6 (0.29 pts.) - Objectives and Conflicts

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Describe the goals and challenges within the game

Your Response:

The objective of the prototype will just be to defeat all of the opponent's units. The last team or player with units remaning wins.

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Task #7 (0.29 pts.) - Game Mechanics

Progress: 100%

Details:

- List each mechanic with supporting details to clearly portray the mechanic

Your Response:

The main mechanic of the game is the units. I want the game to be as simple and approachable as possible, so each type of animal will have a card which describes their amount of health, an ability that changes the rules of the game in some way, and two actions they are capable of using. These actions have set ranges that they can be used within, and each unit has a set number of tiles it is allowed to move each turn.

Each player chooses three or so units to play with, the number of units doesn't matter so long as it is the same between all players. The game starts with players placing their units wherever they wish on their half of the board. The players take turns moving and using each of their units' actions. Each unit is allowed to move seperately from one another and use one of their actions per turn, in whatever order the player chooses. Some actions are attacks against opponents, while others may be supportive and help friendly units.

I also want to add height and verticality to the game, in the form of wooden blocks. The players can place and stack blocks of elevation where they wish on their side of the board while setting up the game. It costs extra tiles worth of movement to move up each height level, but doing so grants extra range to actions against targets at lower height levels.

Beside these, I am also considering extra mechanics to add extra spice or balance

Besides those, I am also considering extra mechanics to add extra spice or balance. One idea is for each player to have a leader unit, which functions like the king from chess. It is weak, can't move much, and defeating it is the game's win condition. I am worried that the game might be prone to snowballing, where having less units left than your opponent makes the game impossible to win. One way I thought of is for units to no longer be limited to one action per turn, and instead for players to gain a fixed amount of "energy" which they can spend to have units use actions (losing units would not decrease the amount of energy gained per turn, so losing units just means the ones remaning can use more actions per turn). Another idea was to have a deck of cards containing random boons and bonuses, which players draw from when one of their units dies.

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Section #2: (1 pt.) Target Audience Analysis

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (1 pt.) - Identify and analyze the game's target audience

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Clearly identify the target audience
- Include analysis of demographics, interests, and gaming habits
- Justification of appeal to target audience

Your Response:

I am a big fan of the strategic nature of combat in games like Dungeons and Dragons, Baldur's Gate 3, and various grand strategy games. But I've been scared out of plenty cool looking games because they come with hundred page long rulebooks and take a million years to play. I've played Stellaris for years and still haven't completed a single game, it is absurd.

I imagine I am not alone in that sentiment, so I figured I should target my game towards people who want the fun of these compelx strategy games without all of the overwhelming bloat.

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Section #3: (1 pt.) Accessibility And Inclusivity Strategies

Progress: 100%

Task #1 (1 pt.) - Outline strategies to make your game accessible and inclusive

Progress: 100%

Details:

- Include considerations for diverse abilities
- Outline inclusivity strategies for a wide audience
- Discuss implementation of noted inclusivity strategies without compromising gameplay

Your Response:

The main disability I'd consider a concern is colorblindness. Fortunately, nothing in my game needs to be color coded, and there are few enough units being used that it should be easy to remember which belong to who.

I also want to include spots on the unit cards that can handle dry-erase markers to record health points, so players don't have to play spreadsheet simulator just to remember how much health their units have remaining.

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Section #4: (2 pts.) Pitch Preparation

Progress: 0%

Task #1 (2 pts.) - Pitch

Progress: 0%

Details:

- Summarize concept and theme
- Compellingly highlight target audience and unique selling points
- Emphasize how the game stands out in the current market

Your Response:

Missing Response

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Section #5: (2 pts.) Visualizing The Game Concept

Progress: 0%

Task #1 (2 pts.) - Sketches/Storyboard

Progress: 0%

Details:

- Provide at least two sketches
- Sketches should accurately represent the game's concept and theme
- Sketches/storyboards should be coherent with game's style and theme

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Section #6: (2 pts.) External Feedback

Progress: 0%

Task #1 (0.67 pts.) - Feedback 1

Progress: 0%

Details:

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

Missing Response

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Task #2 (0.67 pts.) - Feedback 2

Progress: 0%

Details:

- Note the person's name and relation to you

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

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Task #3 (0.67 pts.) - Feedback 3

Progress: 0%

Details:

- Note the person's name and relation to you
- Summarize feedback focusing on concept, mechanics, and style
- Reflect on how the feedback will be used to refine the design

Your Response:

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